

Winter Storm Delivery

D&D 5e Adventure

TL;DR:

- You play as a deer delivering packages in a snowstorm
- This adventure is focused on exploration and resource management
- You are Level 7
- You have a new resource called Stamina, which you spend to travel long distances
- Your attribute scores effect your stamina in unique ways
- Every player will take turns as leader, who navigates, watches for danger, and boosts team morale.
- Recommended race: Reindeerkin (included below)
- You start with some magic items that let you fly, hook to the sleigh, and store your items
- The New Stuff section includes a lot of homebrew options for spells, feats, magic items, etc

Premise

You play as deer pulling a delivery sled to a peninsula about to be frozen over by a blizzard. The cargo you carry will ensure the people of the frozen land can survive the winter storm. How will you survive the blizzard and make all the deliveries?

Info

This adventure will focus more on exploration and resource management, with some combat and roleplaying. Each player will have a new resource: Stamina. This is used to determine how far you can travel in a day. Each of the 6 core attributes will have bonus effects that influence your stamina and how much you use, and this will effect your build decisions.

Tracked Stats

The following will be tracked in this adventure:

- Time
- Distance traveled
- Stamina
- Gold
- Packages (carrying, delivered, lost)
- Temperature
- Material components for spells

Starting Equipment

You start with the following equipment, in addition to your class starting equipment:

- Magic Reindeer Collar (includes Jingle Bells of Holding)
- Sleigh Harness
- 100gp
- Level 7
- 2 common items or 1 uncommon item
- 1 rare item

Additionally, the party starts with the following shared equipment:

- Map of Scheninsel Pensinsula
- Cargo Sleigh
- Reindeer Rations
- 500gp

Setting

This adventure takes place within a year after Kraken Raid, on a peninsula not yet explored in the Minotaur's Maze universe. The season is winter and a huge blizzard is coming to the land.

Allowed Content

All homebrew content in this document are allowed.

Races:

- Only deer races are allowed
- Homebrew welcome
- Recommended: Reindeerkin

Classes:

- All official classes
- Reality Bender
- Non-official subclasses allowed with DM approval
- Multiclassing NOT allowed

Spells:

- Homebrew spells in this document
- If it's on wikidot, and not on the banned list, it's allowed
- Banned:
 - Silvery Barbs
 - Darkness
 - Counterspell
 - Dispel Magic
 - Antimagic Field
 - Wish

- All technomagic spells

Inspiration

This adventure is inspired by *Rudolph, the Red-Blooded Paindeer* adventure from the DM's Secret Weapon magazine, Dec 2023 issue (#24). It was created by William Earl and Doug Wallace. This adventure uses some monster stat blocks, puzzles, and other elements from that adventure.

<https://dndshorts.myshopify.com/collections/digital-content/products/college-of-battle-bard-digital-magazine-24>

Rules

This module is going to be a lot about exploration, route planning, and resource management. Your character has the following new resource: Stamina.

Short Rest

A short rest is 12 minutes, during which you can eat 1 reindeer ration. A reindeer ration restores 25% of your max stamina.

A short rest is usually when you switch leaders.

You may only take a short rest while on the ground or on a boat.

Stamina

Stamina is how far you can travel in a long rest. Under normal conditions, you spend 1 stamina to travel 1 mile at normal pace. Thus that means you can normally go 1 mile per 1 stamina (mps). If you want to conserve your stamina and travel further, you want a higher mps.

Managing your stamina is very important. It's the resource that lets you pull the sleigh. If you run out of stamina, you are no longer able to contribute to pulling the sleigh until you regain it.

Your mps is lower when you travel:

- Faster than your comfy speed
- Across difficult terrain
- Uphill

- Into a head wind
- With more weight than your comfy carry capacity
- In the front while flying
- In the back while walking
- By swimming

Your mps is higher when you travel:

- Slower than your comfy speed
- Across easy terrain
- Downhill
- Out of a tail wind
- With less weight than your comfy carry capacity
- In the back while flying
- In the front while walking
- By boat

Attribute Effects on Stamina

Your attribute scores effect your stamina:

- STR – Increases your carrying capacity
- DEX – Increases your mps
- CON – Increases your max stamina
- INT – Increases the distance you can navigate*
- WIS – Increases the chance you will see upcoming danger*
- CHA – Increases the morale boost you provide for your team*

*only applicable while you're the leader

Stat Formulas

Mark these stats on your character sheet:

- Carrying capacity (lbs) = $100 * STR + 300$
- Miles Per Stamina (MPS) = $3 + DEX$
- Stamina* = $50 * CON + 50$
- Navigation Distance (mi) = $5 * INT + 10$
- Encounter DC = $8 + PB + WIS$
- Leadership = $0.25 * CHA + 0.75$

* Refreshes on a long rest

Carrying Capacity

Your mps scales inversely with the weight you're carrying. While carrying a load that weighs as much as your carrying capacity, your mps is normal. While carrying a load that's twice your carrying capacity, your mps is halved. While carrying a load that's half your carrying capacity or less, your mps is increased by your DEX.

Miles Per Stamina

For 1 point of stamina, you can travel this many miles.

Max Stamina

This is the maximum amount of stamina you can have. A long rest gives you back full stamina.

Navigation Distance

While you are leading, you navigate. This is how far ahead you can navigate per navigation check. After you travel this far, you will have to roll another navigation check.

Encounter DC

While you are leading, the DM has to beat this Encounter DC for you to get ambushed. If the DM fails this check, there might still be an encounter, but you will be able to see it coming from a mile away (quite literally), and can choose to adjust your course. This also works on problems that arise in your journey. The higher this DC is, the earlier you will be able to detect problems.

Leadership

While you are leading, you and your allies get a multiplier to their mps equal to your Leadership multiplier.

EX: If your CHA is +3, then your Leadership multiplier is x1.5, which means you multiply your and your allies' mps times 1.5, which means you can travel farther.

Leading

There is no one leader in the group. Each deer is good at different aspects of leading, so they switch out on a regular basis. While you are leading, you:

- Decide which way to go
- Decide how fast to go
- Decide what method to travel by (see Travel Methods)
- Navigate to your destination (Navigation)
- Look ahead for any trouble (Encounter DC)
- Give your team a morale boost (Leadership)
- Hold the map, and give it commands
- Decide whether to take a short rest

Navigating

While leading, you decide which way to go to get to your destination. To navigate:

1. Declare where you are
2. Declare the method of travel you plan to take
3. Declare the route you plan to take
4. Declare how fast you plan to go
5. Roll for Navigation (1d20 + Intelligence)

From here, the DM will describe what happens. Most likely, you will move along your route a number of miles equal to your Navigation Distance. Or there might be an encounter.

Then you and your team calculate how much stamina they've used. (see Stamina Usage)

Pace Setting

While leading, you can decide how fast the herd goes. Going at normal speed has no effect on your mps. Going twice your speed halves your mps, and going half your speed doubles your mps.

Stamina Usage

When you finish navigating to a waypoint, it's time for you and your team to calculate how many stamina points you've used.

First, calculate your mps. Take your base mps and multiply it by all applicable entries in the following chart:

Condition	Multiplier
Normal	1
Difficult Terrain	0.5
Uphill	0.8
Downhill	1.2
Ground Travel	1
Air Travel	1.25
Water Travel (Swim)	0.3
Water Travel (Boat)	0
Comfy Capacity	1
Double Comfy Capacity	0.5
Half Comfy Capacity	1
Average Speed	1
+1 mph (Ground)	0.8

+1 mph (Air)	0.9
Front (Air)	0.8
Back (Ground)	0.7
No Wind	1
Tail Wind	2
Head Wind	0.5
Perpendicular Wind	0.95

Now you have your net mps.

Second, take your net mps, and do the calculation:

Stamina used = $(1 / \text{mps}) * \text{miles}$

Then reduce your current stamina by that amount. This might make your stamina a fractional value.

Travel Methods

You travel a lot in this module. While traveling, you spend stamina for each mile you travel. You can choose to travel on foot, by flying, or by swimming or boat. Each of these methods have varying difficulty levels when encountering common problems in your journey.

Method	Terrain	Encounters	Wind	Cold
Footing	Moderate	Hard	Easy	Moderate
Flying	Easy	Easy	Hard	Hard
Swimming	Hard	Easy	Easy	Hard
Boating	Easy	Easy	Easy	Easy

Footing

While on foot, you have to deal with difficult terrain and encounters with monsters are more common. However, you are immune to the wind effects of the blizzard.

Flying

While flying, you have less chance of encountering enemies, and can get to the destination quicker and without worrying about terrain, but you are very susceptible to getting blown around by the wind. You might also get lost due to the lack of landmarks.

Swimming

While swimming, you are less likely to encounter enemies and you don't get blown around by the wind. If you stay near the shore, you also don't get pushed around by the waves enough to matter. However, swimming is very slow, and you can get cold easily.

Boating

While taking a boat, you can rest. However, you have to pay the toll each time to get on a boat. It's also faster than swimming, though not as fast as going by foot or by flight.

New Stuff

There's a lot of homebrew content made just for this adventure. The following content was all made by me, shieldgenerator7, specifically for this adventure.

Reindeerkin

Reindeerkin are human-like reindeer who can walk on two legs or on all fours. They can think and reason like humans, and can run fast and carry lots of weight like reindeer.

Ability Score Increase

Your Constitution increases by 2 and your Strength by 1.

Age

Reindeerkin reach maturity around 14 and can live as long as 50.

Alignment

Reindeerkin prefer things to stay consistent, and dislike change. They tend towards lawful alignments.

Size

On all fours, they can reach 3ft tall. On two legs, they can be as big as 6ft tall. Your size is Medium.

Speed

Your base walking speed is 30ft, increased to 60ft when on all fours.

Winter Coat

You have resistance to Cold damage and advantage on saving throws to resist the effects of cold weather.

Languages

You speak common and 1 other language of your choice.

Keen Hearing

You have advantage on ability checks involving sound.

Darkvision

You have darkvision out to 90 feet.

Antlers

You have antlers attached to your head. You can use them as melee weapons that you are proficient with, and they deal 1d6 + your Strength modifier piercing damage. They can also be used as a spellcasting focus.

Feats

Bulky

You're heavy thick and muscular.

- +1 Strength
- +50 lb. weight
- Your carrying capacity is increased by your weight times STR divided by 2
- Advantage on saving throws to resist being forcibly moved

Cervid Engine

You're good at efficiently using your stamina.

- +1 Dexterity
- Add your PB to your mps. This requires Concentration.

- Whenever you regain stamina, multiply the amount gained by x1.5
- You can regain stamina over your max stamina

Cold Endurance

You adapt to resist the cold, gaining the following benefits:

- +1 Constitution
- Advantage on saving throws to resist the cold
- Advantage on saving throws to resist spell effects that deal cold damage
- Resistance to cold damage

Orienteer Expert

You are really skilled at observing your surroundings and reading a map.

- +1 Intelligence
- Add your PB to Perception checks to spot landmarks
- Add your PB to Investigation checks to identify where you are
- Advantage on Navigation checks
- Add your PB to your Navigation Distance

Reindeer Vision

You can see all around you at all times.

- +1 Wisdom
- Advantage on Perception checks to spot landmarks
- Advantage on Perception checks to spot threats and potential problems
- Advantage on initiative rolls against enemies you saw coming
- Add your PB to Investigation rolls to discern information about objects and creatures from a distance
- +90ft darkvision

Natural Born Leader

You know how to inspire your team.

- +1 Charisma
- During a short rest while you are the leader, your team gets a multiplier to any stamina they gain equal to your Leadership Multiplier.
- While you are the leader, you may spend any amount of stamina up to your $CHA * 10$ to restore that much stamina to an ally within 20ft of you. Once you use this feature, you can't do so again until you finish a short rest or long rest.
- While you are the leader, when you leave a town or safe place, double your Leadership Multiplier for the next stretch of your journey.

Ki Endurance

You channel your inner energy to survive the cold, gaining the following benefits:

- +1 max Ki point
- While not the leader, whenever you spend 1 or more Ki points, you restore an amount of stamina equal to your max stamina times your Dex score divided by 100
- When making a saving throw to resist the cold or a spell effect that does cold damage, you may spend 1 Ki point to gain a +10 bonus to your roll.

(Magic) Items

Magic Reindeer Collar

4lb – Attunement by Ungulate – Uncommon, Rare, Very Rare

While wearing this collar and standing on all fours, you gain the following benefits:

- Flight Speed of 90ft
- Retrieve items from the attached Jingle Bells of Holding with a voice command (Rare)
- Cast the Sending spell as a free action at will with no components. Your target must be another creature wearing a Magic Reindeer Collar. (Rare)
- Telekinetic feat (Very Rare)

It is lined with Jingle Bells of Holding. How many is determined by its rarity:

Rarity	Jingle Bells
Uncommon	3
Rare	5
Very Rare	7

You automatically attune to the collar when you put it on, and automatically unattuned to it when you take it off. The Jingle Bells of Holding on this collar can only be accessed by the creature attuned to this item.

Jingle Bell of Holding

0.1lb – Uncommon

This bell jingles like a normal jingle bell, but with a lower pitch. As an object interaction, you may stow 1 item in the jingle bell. While holding an item, its jingle has a higher pitch. As an object interaction, you may retrieve 1 item from the jingle bell. When you retrieve an equippable object from it, you may equip it in the same free action.

The jingle bell has a max capacity of 1 item. Its weight doesn't change when you put an item inside it. Otherwise, it works like a Bag of Holding.

Alternatively, you can store any amount of copper, silver, and gold coins in a jingle bell as "1 item". When you retrieve it, you may retrieve a portion of the coins in exact change instead of all of it. When the jingle bell has coins in it, its jingles sound like coin clinks.

Scheninsel Peninsula Map

0.1lb – Rare

A magic map of the peninsula. While holding it, you can give it commands to update itself using information that you have.

Sleigh Harness

3lb

This harness fits over your back and allows you to quickly connect and disconnect from the sleigh. While within 20ft of the sleigh, you can use an action to connect to it. You may disconnect as an action. While connected:

- You can help pull the sleigh
- When you move further from the sleigh than your starting distance, the sleigh is pulled with you
- If you run out of stamina, you are auto-disconnected from the sleigh

If you have 0 stamina, you are not able to connect to the sleigh.

Reindeer Ration

0.2lb

During a short rest, you may choose to eat a Reindeer Ration. It restores 25% of your stamina, and heals 25% of your health.

If you are not a deer race, make a DC20 Constitution saving throw. On a failure, you take a 1d4 poison damage and do not gain the benefits of this ration.

Ration

Standard ration, edible for most species. During a short rest, you may choose to eat a Ration. It restores 10% of your health.

Spells

Glow

Illusion Cantrip

1 action – 30ft range – S – 1 hour

You choose a target within range and cause it to glow. The target must be no larger than a 6"x6" cube. The target can be an object or creature, or part of an object or creature. The glow casts bright light out to a range of 5ft, and dim light out to a range of 60ft. You choose the color of the glow when you cast this spell.

If you cast this spell again, the previous effects fade away.

Artificer, Bard, Cleric, Sorcerer, Wizard

Snowball

Transmutation Cantrip

1 bonus action – 30ft range – S – Instantaneous

You choose a blob of snow within range, and magically compact it into a snowball. You then launch it at any target within 30ft of it. Make a ranged spell attack on the target. On a hit, deal 1d4 + spellcasting ability modifier cold damage.

Druid, Sorcerer, Warlock, Wizard

Snowfort

1st-level Transmutation

1 action – 15ft range – V – 1 hour

You choose a blob of snow within range, and build a snow fort out of it. The snow fort has room for 1 medium-sized creature. If you spend a short rest in the snowfort, it counts as a warm place for the rest of its duration.

Artificer, Druid, Wizard

Northern Star

2nd-level Divination

1 action – Ritual – 50mi range – V M (a map) – Concentration – 1 day

While holding or looking at the map, choose a point on the map. A glowing star hovers over the corresponding location in the world. The star looks like a northern star. It is always at the same elevation as you, always appears the same size no matter how far you are, and is always visible, even when behind walls and other obstructions. The star is only visible to you, and does not shed light of any kind.

When you cast this spell, if the point on the map is not within range in the world, the spell fails.

Bard, Cleric, Ranger

Snowman

2nd-level Transmutation

1 action – 5ft range – V S M (a hat worth at least 1gp, which the spell consumes) – 1 day

You place the hat on a mound of snow within range, and a snowman comes to life beneath it.

The snowman will follow your commands to the best of its ability. It cannot speak, but it can understand the language you used as the vocal component of this spell. It acts on its own turn.

Artificer, Bard, Wizard

Process Meat

2nd-Level Transmutation

1 action – Ritual 10ft range – S M (a knife) – Instantaneous

You choose a dead creature within range, and slice it up into food. For every 10 lbs of meat in the body, you make 1 Reindeer Ration or 1 Ration. When the spell is finished, only the bones remain.

If the dead creature is an ungulate, this spell fails.

Druid (Optional), Ranger

Saving Grace

1st-level Abjuration

1 reaction – 30ft range – V – 1 round*

When a creature you can see or hear casts a spell, you can use your reaction to cast Saving Grace.

You choose 1 creature of your choice within range and give them magic resistance. Choose one of the 6 core attributes. Until the start of your next turn, they have advantage on all saving throws that use the attribute you chose.

At Higher Levels. For each spell slot level above 1st, you can target 1 additional creature within range.

Cleric, Paladin (Optional), Sorcerer, Wizard

Wind Shroud

3rd-level Abjuration

1 action – Ritual – 60ft range – V S M (a cup of water) – Concentration – 1 hour

You choose 3 targets in range and protect them from wind. For the duration, each target has advantage on all checks and saves to resist being forcibly moved or drawn off course by wind or moving air. Additionally, all ranged attacks that target them or move through their space have disadvantage.

Druid, Ranger, Sorcerer, Wizard

Unweave

3rd-level Abjuration

1 action – 120ft range – 10ft radius – V S – Instantaneous

You choose a point within range, and a burst of antimagic appears instantly. The antimagic burst has a radius of 10ft. Inside the burst, each ongoing spell or magical effect of 3rd level or lower gets dispelled.

At Higher Levels. For each spell slot level above 3rd, the level of spell this dispels increases by 1.

Artificer, Bard, Cleric, Druid, Paladin, Sorcerer, Wizard

Magic Suppression

8th-level Abjuration

1 action – 120ft range – 30ft radius – V S M (an iron bead) – Concentration – 1 hour

You choose a point within range, and a sphere of magic suppression appears. The sphere has a radius of 10ft.

While inside the sphere, a creature:

- Has disadvantage on Constitution saving throws to maintain concentration.
- Must succeed on an Arcana check to cast a spell, with a DC equal to 20 + the spell's level.
- Has advantage on all saving throws to resist the effects of a spell or magical effect.
- Cannot gain or regain spell slots, sorcery points, spell points, uses of magic-related features, or magical item charges.
- Has its spell save DC and spell attack modifier reduced by 8.

As a bonus action, you may move the center of the sphere up to 30ft to a point that's still within range of you.

Cleric, Wizard

New Stuff (Part 2)

This is homebrew content pulled from other sources. Unless otherwise stated, it is from DM's Secret Weapon, Dec 2023 issue (#24).

Spells

Charge

1st-level Abjuration

1 action – Self – V S – Concentration – 1 minute

You fortify yourself with magic, building power in preparation for an explosive burst. When you cast this spell, and at the start of each of your turns, you gain 1d4 Temporary Hit Points.

When you cast a levelled spell using an action, you can choose to stop concentrating on this spell. If you do, treat that spell as if it were cast at one level higher than the level of the spell slot you expended to cast it.

Icicle Lancer

2nd-level Evocation

1 action – 30ft range – V S M (a snowflake preserved in amber) – Instantaneous

Roll 1d4. You conjure a number of icicles equal to the result on the die, which you can hurl at targets you can see within 30 feet. You can hurl them at one target or several. Make a ranged spell attack roll for each icicle. On a hit, the icicle deals 2d4 cold damage.

At Higher levels. When you cast this spell with a spell slot of 3rd-or-4th level, the size of the die you roll to determine how many icicles you conjure and the damage dice of each icicle increase to a d6. These dice increase to a d8 if you cast it with a 5th-or-6th level spell slot, a d10 if you cast it with a 7th-8th level spell slot, and a d12 if you cast it with a 9th level spell slot.

Trace

4th-level Abjuration

1 reaction – 60ft range – V S – Instantaneous

When you see a creature within 60ft cast a spell, you may cast Trace as a reaction.

You attempt to trace the somatic and verbal components of a spell you can see being cast. If that spell is of a level lower than the slot level you used to cast this spell, and does not require Material components with a monetary value (e.g. a gem worth at least 50 gp), you successfully trace it, and you can cast that spell using this reaction without expending a further spell slot or requiring material components. Your casting of the spell happens immediately after the initial spellcaster casts it. If the spellcaster is casting a spell level equal to or higher than the slot level you used to cast this spell, make an ability check using your spellcasting ability. The DC equals 10 + the spell's level. On a success, you successfully trace the spell.

Feats

All's Well That Ends Spell

You are well practiced in the art of battling other spellcasters, granting you the following benefits.

- Increase your Constitution, Intelligence, or Charisma score by 1, to a maximum of 20.
- If a spell you cast is countered, you regain the spell slot used to cast that spell, and can use the same action, bonus action, or reaction you used to cast the countered spell to cast a cantrip in its place.
- A creature damaged by a spell you cast has disadvantage on Constitution saving throws to maintain its concentration.
- If you lose concentration on a spell as a result of taking damage, you can use your reaction to deal force damage equal to 5 times that spell's level to one creature you can see within 30 feet of you.

Ki Thief

Your command of ki is so great that you have the power to manipulate the life force of others, granting you the following benefits.

- Your unarmed strikes and monk weapons score a critical hit on a 19 or a 20.
- When you score a critical hit against a creature with an unarmed strike or monk weapon, you regain 2 ki points.

Hunter's Mastery

Your focus in battle is nigh-unshakable, granting you the following benefits.

- You learn the spell hunter's mark. It counts as a ranger spell for you, but it doesn't count against the number of ranger spells you know.
- When you roll for initiative, you can use your reaction to cast hunter's mark. Once you use this feature, you cannot do so again until you finish a short or long rest.
- You have advantage on Constitution saving throws to maintain concentration on your ranger spells.
- If the target of your hunter's mark 0 hit points before the spell ends, you can use a reaction to mark a new creature. You can use this feature a number of times equal to your proficiency bonus, regaining all expended uses when you finish a long rest.

Conditions

Freezing Condition

Source: DM's Secret Weapon, Issue #20

- A creature with the freezing condition has disadvantage on dexterity-based attack rolls and saving throws, cannot make opportunity attacks, has a -2 penalty to its AC, a -10 foot penalty to its movement speed, and gains one point of exhaustion each hour.
- Creatures with a resistance to cold damage make saves to resist the freezing condition at advantage, and creatures with an immunity to cold damage are immune to the freezing condition.
- A creature who spends 10 minutes warming themselves from a sufficient source of heat can end the freezing condition on themselves. Moving to a warm location, such as a heated tavern sheltered from the elements, will also end the condition after 10 minutes.

(A Note On Fire Damage: A GM might consider an optional rule to end the freezing condition for a creature if that creature takes sufficient fire damage, or is set on fire. If so, it is recommended that the creature take fire damage at least once per turn, every turn, for 10 rounds to end the condition. A simple firebolt spell will be insufficient to rid the target of the deep, bone-aching chill of the freezing condition.)